

# Zadkiel AHARONIAN

Kubernetes Platform Engineer / Site Reliability Engineer / OSS Maintainer

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I'm a *developer* who builds and runs **platforms**, drawn to two problems: reliability you can sleep through, and platforms other engineers actually want to use. I've run Kubernetes at scale from public and sovereign clouds through on-prem to the edge, but I'm proudest of the open source I build and maintain, and the **1,000+ PRs I've merged upstream**. Right now I'm exploring how agentic AI changes the way platforms get built.

## EXPERIENCE

### Cloud Specialist · Airbus Aircraft Jun 2024 — Present

Cloud-native and edge platforms for next-generation onboard aircraft systems.

- Delivered 5+ MVPs for next-generation onboard platforms, from concept to production-ready.
- Designed Kubernetes foundations for onboard application management and rollout-constrained environments.
- Built Varnish-based onboard video/content distribution and **Jetson/GPU real-time computer-vision** pipelines.
- Built an AWS landing zone (Control Tower, AFT) with self-service account vending, and designed its dev-to-prod security gates.

### DevOps Consultant · CCL Consulting Apr 2019 — Present

Kubernetes platform engineering and DevOps consulting in a multi-client service center, across public and sovereign clouds.

- Led development of a **self-service Kubernetes platform product** and Go-based CLI to bootstrap clusters and application stacks from declarative config, with GitOps delivery, layered Helm/Kustomize composition, secret hydration and repeatable local/cloud/bare-metal environments.
- Developed a **Kubernetes compliance engine** for real-time security and best-practice visibility across developers, compliance teams and operators.
- Delivering platform maintenance and enhancements across client environments using immutable infrastructure, GitOps workflows and modern security practices to 10+ client teams.

### Site Reliability Engineer · Carrefour Dec 2020 — May 2024

Internal Kubernetes platform team for Carrefour product teams, operating shared clusters and platform services across GKE, Rancher RKE, Azure IaaS/Kubespray and AKS.

- Operated and modernized 10+ Kubernetes clusters across multiple clouds, up to 200 nodes each, serving 50 product teams.
- Led **RKE to AKS migration** with GitOps, immutable infrastructure and security guardrails, delivering high availability and zero-downtime cluster upgrades.
- Built self-service Kubernetes platform capabilities, **GreenIT** resource-efficiency practices, runbooks, alert tuning and active on-call incident response.
- Developed and contributed to Kubernetes controllers/operators for multi-tenancy, logging and platform automation.

### Software Engineer / Infrastructure Architect · Jan 2016 — Dec 2020

Earlier engineering roles

Airbus Group Inc. and Aestetype Design: Python network/security automation, Tufin/NetBox/Centreon/Palo Alto/IPFabric data flows, Jenkins/Vault foundations, and Docker/Kubernetes product modernization.

## OPEN SOURCE

### Selected Cloud Native OSS MAINTAINER · CONTRIBUTOR

Maintainer: **aslafy-z/helm-git** (350+ stars), **stakater/application**; core contributor to **kube-logging/logging-operator**. 1,000+ merged PRs across the ecosystem.

Contributor: Argo CD, Cilium, Kyverno, Talos, Helm, Kargo, Scaleway CCM, Ansible, Renovate, Prometheus Operator, External Secrets, Pluto...

Kubernetes · Helm · Operators · GitOps · Logging · Networking

### Production-grade homelab

Talos/Kubernetes GitOps lab used to validate real platform patterns: Cilium, KubeSpan, Rook/Ceph, SOPS/age, identity, observability and self-hosted services.

Talos · GitOps · Cilium · Rook/Ceph · SOPS/age

## SKILLS

### Kubernetes / Platform

Kubernetes · Talos · AKS · GKE · EKS · RKE · kubeadm · Cluster API · Rook/Ceph · Operators · Chaos engineering

### Policy / Networking / Identity

Cilium · Calico · Canal · OPA · Kyverno · Gateway API · ingress-nginx · Traefik · Envoy Gateway · Keycloak/OIDC

### GitOps / Delivery

Helm · Kustomize · Argo CD · Flux CD · Argo Workflows · Renovate · GitLab CI · GitHub Actions · Jenkins

### IaC / Cloud / Edge

Terraform · Ansible · Packer · Vault · NVIDIA Jetson · AWS · Azure · GCP · Scaleway · OVHcloud

### Observability

Prometheus · VictoriaMetrics · Mimir · Thanos · Grafana · Loki · Fluent Bit · Fluentd

### Programming

Go · Python · TypeScript · Shell · Rust · C · C++

### AI

Computer vision · GPU compute · Agentic coding · AI-assisted workflows · Tokenmaxxing

## EDUCATION

### University of Kent

MSc, Computer Science - Cyber Security  
Sep 2016 — Sep 2017

### EPITECH

Engineering degree, Computer Programming  
Dec 2013 — Dec 2018

## CERTIFICATIONS

### Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

The Linux Foundation · Dec 2021

### Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)

The Linux Foundation · Feb 2023

## INTERESTS

### Technology

IoT · Technology watch · Self-hosting · AI

### Sports & outdoors

Hiking · Rock climbing · Cycling

### Food & fermentation

Hot pepper sauces · Gourmet pickles · World cuisines

## LANGUAGES

|         |        |
|---------|--------|
| French  | Native |
| English | Fluent |